

Recruitment Workflow: Applicant to Fellow

How a candidate goes from applying for a sanctioned research position to becoming a Research Fellow with full portal access. Unlike the other eight workflows, this one is not built on the standard approval-stage engine — it is its own multi-step pipeline, because most of its steps (advertising, screening, interviewing) have no office-escalation chain of their own. The one moment it does need one — approving the final merit list — is handed off to the standard route (see the separate Manpower Document reference).

Raised by Applicant, against a position the PI has advertised

Key actors Applicant, PI, Selection Committee, Dean, HOD

Terminal outcome Applicant role removed, Fellow role granted

PIPELINE

1 Register & verify email

A candidate registers as an Applicant and confirms their email address. Verification gates **applying**, not signing in — an unverified account can browse but cannot submit an application.

2 PI advertises the position

The PI requests an advertisement for a sanctioned manpower position on their project; the office publishes it with a closing date. If too few candidates apply, the PI can re-advertise, which opens a new round and closes out the old one.

3 Applicant applies

The verified Applicant submits an application to the open advertisement — qualifications, experience, contact details. Only one active application per candidate per drive is allowed.

4 Screening committee reviews

The PI submits a Screening Committee — by BRD rule, the PI as Chairman, the Co-PI, and one faculty member nominated by the Dean. The committee screens each applicant as eligible or ineligible; an ineligible candidate's application ends here.

5 Selection committee is formed & interviews scheduled

A separate Selection Committee is submitted — the HOD as Chairman, the PI, and exactly two nominees (one from the PI's department, one external, and the external nominee must hold Associate Professor rank or above). Interviews can only be scheduled once payment against the project's grant has actually been received. Interview mode defaults to offline; an online interview needs the Dean's prior approval on record.

WHY The screening and selection committees are deliberately different bodies with different chairs — screening is the PI's own filtering pass, chaired by the PI; selection is the department's formal judgment, chaired by the HOD with an external check built in. Requiring a senior external nominee keeps any single project's hiring from being purely an internal decision.

6 Merit list is prepared and signed

The PI submits a ranked merit list of the interviewed candidates. Every selection committee member must then digitally sign the merit list before it can go forward — a partial signature does not count.

7 Dean approves the merit list (via office escalation)

Approve Reject

Once fully signed, the Dean raises the merit list into the standard seven-stage office-escalation route (Raised → Signed Copy Uploaded → Assigned → Forwarded → Forwarded to OSRC → Forwarded to DR → Director) as a Manpower Document workflow — the one point in the whole recruitment pipeline that runs through the shared workflow engine.

8 Offer letter is issued

Once the merit list workflow reaches Director approval, the PI can issue the offer letter to the top-ranked, selected candidate — but only once payment against the position, with a confirmed bank transaction reference, is on record. Issuing the offer automatically closes out every other pending applicant in that drive as not selected.

9

Candidate joins; PI records joining

The selected candidate joins, and the PI records the joining details — bank account, ID proof numbers, joining date, and tenure end date.

10

HOD forwards the joining report

[Forward](#)

The HOD reviews and forwards the joining report to the Dean.

11

Dean approves the joining report

[Approve](#)

The Dean's approval is the final act of this pipeline. It immediately promotes the candidate's account: the Applicant role is removed and the Fellow role is granted, giving them access to everything a Fellow can do in the portal — including raising fellowship claims (see the separate Fellowship Claim reference).

WHY The offer letter and joining report both gate on a real, confirmed payment (a bank transaction reference, not merely a receipt record being present) rather than on the paperwork alone. This exists so a candidate can never be told they're hired, or promoted to Fellow, ahead of the money that actually funds their stipend.

DOCUMENTS GENERATED ALONG THE WAY

DOCUMENT	WHEN
Advertisement	Published when the position opens
Screening Proforma	Screening committee review
Selection Proforma	Selection committee / interview stage
Minutes of Selection Committee	After interviews, before merit list
Merit List	Ranked list, pending committee signatures
Offer Letter	After Director approval and confirmed payment
Joining Letter	After the candidate joins

